

Immediate Action Items: Next 3 Weeks (Before Week 1)

Status: You're 3 weeks from NFL Week 1 and CFB Week 0

Goal: Paper trade both sports through August, validate models, go live Week 1

Bankroll: 2,500-3,000 units allocated (60% NFL props, 40% CFB spreads)

THIS WEEK (Week of Aug 25)

CRITICAL (do by EOD Friday)

Set up line tracking workflow (30 mins)

Create Google Sheet or local CSV with columns:



Date | Book | Game | Player | Market | Line | Price | Timestamp

Add daily reminder to check DK, FanDuel, BetMGM at 10 AM ET

Test: Pull lines for one NFL game, log them

Build CFB dataset (2-3 hours)

Scrape ESPN CFB schedules (2021-2026)

Pull 247Sports recruiting ranks (lagged 1-2 years)

Merge into single CSV with columns:



team | year | wins | games | recruiting_rank | qb_same | coach_tenure

Store at: `edge-index/data/cfb/team_historical.csv`

Sanity check: Bama rating should be ~0.75-0.80, FCS team ~0.30

Write CFB power ranking function (1-2 hours)

Use script provided: `cfb_power_ranking_model.py`

Test on 3 teams (Bama, Texas, Ohio State)

Verify output: Bama beats Texas ~55-60% by model

Store in `edge-index/models/cfb_spreads_2027.py`

Create paper trading tracker (30 mins)

Google Sheet or CSV with columns:



Set up daily formula to auto-compute: ROI, win%, CLV

🟡 IMPORTANT (by end of week)

Recalibrate NFL model for 2027

Your 2026 model had 1.12pp win-rate miss (52.37% vs 53.49%)

Adjust model coefficients upward by ~0.5-1.0pp

Store calibration in `edge-index/data/nfl/market_calibration.json`:

```

{
  "rec_yds": {"roi": 0.0862, "w%": 0.5758, "bets": 165},
  "receptions": {"roi": 0.0927, "w%": 0.5762, "bets": 151},
  "pass_yds": {"roi": -0.0968, "w%": 0.4797, "bets": 148},
  "rush_att": {"roi": -0.0843, "w%": 0.4741, "bets": 135}
}

```

Test line-pulling from edge-index

Verify your NFL model can consume opening lines from DK, FanDuel, BetMGM

Flag bets where model_edge $\geq$ +1.5%

Do a mock run: Pull lines for this weekend's NFL game, score your edge

WEEK 2 (Aug 25 - Sept 1)

Daily (10 mins/day)

- ☐ 10 AM: Check DK, FanDuel, BetMGM for opening props
- ☐ Log in tracking sheet
- ☐ Run model; identify Tier 1 & 2 edges (edge $\geq$ +1.5%)
- ☐ Paper-bet top 3-5 edges in tracker

Weekly (Monday & Friday)

- ☐ Monday: Run CFB power rankings for weekend games; paper-bet spreads
- ☐ Friday: Compile closing prices, calculate actual CLV, log results

Deliverables by End of Week 2

- ☐ 50-75 paper bets placed across NFL props + CFB spreads
- ☐ Weekly performance report showing ROI by market, by book, by timing
- ☐ CFB model tested on 2-3 games (verify calibration)

Go/No-Go Check:

If ROI > -2%: proceed

If ROI < -5%: pause and audit

WEEK 3 (Sept 1 - Sept 8)

Daily (15 mins/day)

Same as Week 2, but now NFL Week 1 + CFB Week 1 live

Track both paper and any early live bets

End-of-Week Analysis

☐ Compile August paper trading summary (100-120 total bets)

☐ Calculate win% by market, by book, by timing

☐ Verify placement timing hypothesis:

48-96h window should capture +2.0% to +2.5%

<12h window should show fading (-5% to -6%)

DECISION: Go Live or Extend?

☒ **Green Light (proceed to live):**

August paper ROI: +0.5% to +3%

Win rate: $\geq 52\%$

CFB model calibration: within $\pm 2\%$

Placement window: 48-96h shows edge preservation

☒ **Red Light (extend paper trading):**

August paper ROI: < -5%

Any market loses > 15%

CFB model off by > 5%

☐ **Yellow Light (live with 50% bankroll):**

August paper ROI: -2% to +0.5%

Win rate: 50-52%

→ Start live with \$5K-\$7.5K, keep \$5K-\$7.5K for validation

Key Metrics to Track Daily



Cumulative through Week 3:

ROI by Sport:

- NFL props: ____% (target: +1% to +2%)
- CFB spreads: ____% (target: +0.5% to +2%)

Win Rate:

- Overall: ____% (target: ≥52%)
- NFL: ____% | CFB: ____%

By Market (NFL only):

- rec_yds: ____% ROI
- receptions: ____% ROI
- pass_att: ____% ROI
- pass_yds: ____% ROI

By Book:

- DraftKings: ____% ROI
- FanDuel: ____% ROI
- BetMGM: ____% ROI

By Timing (hours before kickoff):

- 0-12h: ____% ROI (expect -5% to -2%)
- 12-48h: ____% ROI (expect -1% to +1%)
- 48-96h: ____% ROI (expect +1% to +2%)
- 96h+: ____% ROI (expect 0% to +1%)

Files You Now Have

PRE_WEEK1_PLAYBOOK.md — Full strategic plan (read this first)

cfb_power_ranking_model.py — Copy to [edge-index/models/](#); run weekly

weekly_performance_tracker.py — Copy to [edge-index/scripts/](#); run every Friday

NFL_PROPS_TRACKING_TEMPLATE.csv — Copy as your master tracking sheet

NFL_PROP_AUDIT_ANSWERS.md — Reference for 2026 learnings

Right Now: The Next 3 Hours

If you have 3 hours this evening:

Hour 1: Set up Google Sheet for line tracking (30 mins) + CFB data scrape (30 mins)

Hour 2: Build CFB power ranking function (60 mins)

Hour 3: Create paper trading tracker + add daily calendar reminder (60 mins)

By EOD tonight, you'll be ready to start tracking Week 1 of CFB (Sept 1) and NFL opening props.

The 2026 Audit TL;DR (Don't Forget)

Finding	Action
rec_yds +8.62% ROI	Allocate 30% of bets here
pass_yds -9.68% ROI	Avoid or test minimal
48-96h = +2.1% ROI	Prefer this placement window
<12h = -6.0% ROI	Avoid last-minute bets
-20.7pp closing line fading	Expected; test if earlier entry helps
1.12pp win-rate miss	Recalibrate model upward

Questions Before You Start?

Need help setting up the Google Sheet?

Want guidance on which Python version for CFB script?

Unsure about recruiting rank data sources?

Reply in chat and I'll unblock you immediately.

Week 1 Success = Live Money

Once you hit the Week 1 paper trading targets ( in the Go/No-Go section above), we flip the switch to live money with real capital. You'll keep the same infrastructure, same tier system, same discipline—just real \$ instead of paper.

You've got this. Let's get it.